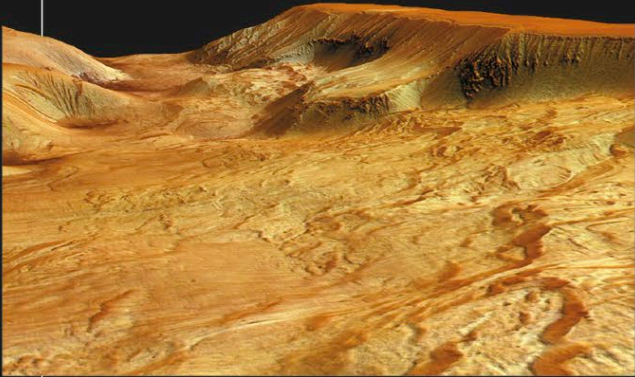


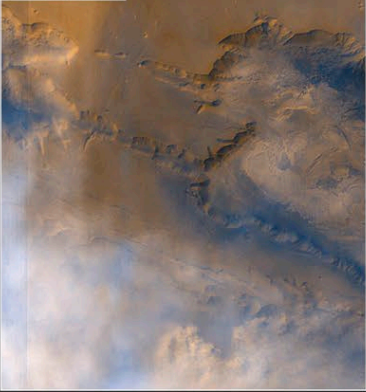
Ophir; Candor; and, to their south, Melas Chasma. The long Coprates Chasma stretches out to the east, where it meets the broader Eos Chasma. The name of the whole system, Valles Marineris, means "Valleys of the Mariner." The Mariner in this case is the Mariner 9 mission that mapped

LOOKING WEST THROUGH OPHIR CHASMA
Over billions of years, Ophir Chasma has widened as its walls have collapsed and slumped downward, covering the floor with debris.



EASTERN EOS CHASMA
Water flowed through this broad chasma, out of the Valles Marineris and into a series of valleys and channels.

the entire surface of Mars and took the first close-up images of this area. More recent craft, such as Mars Global Surveyor and Mars Express, have provided more detailed coverage. For example, their surveys have revealed layered rock in the canyon walls that could be a profile of the different lava flows that built the plains that the canyons cut through. Rocks on the floor may have formed from windborne dust layers or by deposits in ancient lakes that once filled the canyons.



DUST STORM
Wind blows through the canyons carrying dust. The pinkish dust cloud at the bottom of this image is moving north across the junction of Ius Chasma and Melas Chasma. The higher, bluish-white clouds are water ice.

EXPLORING SPACE

MARS EXPRESS'S STEREO CAMERA

The High Resolution Stereo Camera onboard Mars Express began its 2-year program to map the entire Martian surface in January 2004. Its nine charge-coupled device sensors record data one line at a time. Downward, backward, and forward views are used to build up 3-D images. The Super Resolution Channel provides more detailed information.

